



to ignore certain applications and/or file types, and it is also an easier means to delete private data such as history and cookies from multiple browsers with a single click. Besides that, the application lets you disable programs that automatically boot with your OS, thus helping you manage resources better for smoother performance.

CCleaner has a built-in application manager that lets you rename and uninstall applications, as well as a drive cleaner tool that lets you securely delete files preventing any chance of recovery using file recovery tools. The app also includes a windows registry cleaner. However, the boost in performance from this is minimal and is almost not worth the risk of accidentally deleting crucial registry values. Use this particular feature with caution.



Integrate with Pushbullet

Unlink the other tips on this list, Pushbullet is not a performance-boosting tool. However, it does help increase productivity, especially in tasks that require you to switch between multiple devices such as your laptop and mobile phone. It allows you to mirror notifications from your phone to your laptop, as well as reply to text messages. Furthermore, you can push text, links, and images between your phone and laptop, opening the door to a wide array of applications.

For example, if a friend sends you a link on a messaging app like WhatsApp while you are using your laptop, you can push the link to the Pushbullet app (or browser extension, depending on your OS) and view the content on a larger screen instead of your phone. Similarly, if you want to share some text or a link with a friend via the same messaging app, simply push

the text/link to your phone. The potential applications are endless.



Check for Driver Updates

Updating outdated hardware drivers especially important if you have a laptop that is over three years old. Device manufacturers keep releasing updates to drivers for integrated devices such as your on-board graphics card and motherboard chipset, which includes drivers for your sound device and LAN adapter. You can find updates for your laptop's hardware by visiting



A 4GB USB drive should suffice for ReadyBoost

the manufacturer's website and searching for the support page for your particular model.

In the case of chipset drivers, updates are far and few between and most do not contribute any noticeably significant performance boosts. Hence, it is recommended that you only update these drivers if you are experiencing hardware issues. However, if your laptop comes with a dedicated mobile graphics card, ensure you are always on the latest version of drivers as these drivers are updated often and include significant performance upgrades, especially for new games that require driver optimization post release. In short: driver update equals slightly increased frame rates.



Get an external WiFi Adapter

Seeing as how a laptop is primarily for wireless use, wireless internet is nothing short of an indispensable feature. Therefore, it's imperative to ensure that your WiFi connection is running at its optimal setting, and there are quite a few measures you can take to improve connection strength and stability. First and foremost, upgrade to a wireless-n or wireless-ac router if you are still using a wireless-g one. This helps you gain improved internet speeds (limited to that given by your ISP of course) as well as faster transfer of data via local wireless intranet, ideal for streaming media (Chromecast users take note). In addition, AC devices have a much improved net battery usage if connected to a wireless-ac network

Alternatively, you can upgrade the PCI wireless receiver in your laptop or simply plug in a USB antenna receiver for improved reception. The physical antenna on the USB receiver will help you capture signals in places where you would earlier encounter WiFi dead zones. Beginners should note that installing a new PCI card on your laptop will take some homework as you have to open the laptop's back case.



Make use of Windows ReadyBoost

Users who have their laptops equipped with Windows Vista or better can make use of Microsoft's proprietary ReadyBoost feature, which improves memory-based performance (application switching, response times, etc.) on older systems with less RAM (1 GB or 512). Using the feature is as simple as plugging in a USB pen drive, right-click it in "My Computer," select "Properties," and click

on the "Dedicate this device to ReadyBoost" option.

Note that not all USB devices support this feature; Windows will allow you to test the drive before you can assign it as a ReadyBoost device. Some manufactures have even begun to add the "Enhanced for Windows ReadyBoost" tagline for their products, indicating that the device has been tested by Microsoft to confirm ReadyBoost compatibility. ReadyBoost will exhibit some improved performance during non-sequential read-write operations as flash drives are faster during non-sequential reads. Don't expect a lightning fast solution to your RAM woes, but whatever little performance boost you get may be worth it.



Consider Switching to Linux

If you use your laptop primarily for browsing the Internet or watching movies, there is a possibility that switching to a lighter, relatively safer operating system such as a Linux build will significantly improve your UX experience. Gamers will have time switching to a Linux build because most modern day games are only available for Windows. First time Linux users should try either the Ubuntu or Fedora build for a good-looking, hassle-free distribution.

Most Linux distributions such as Ubuntu and Fedora are free to download, so you can have little complaint about the cost. Installation is also easy: burn the ISO for these distributions on to a DVD or load it on a USB drive using ISO-burning software such as "Universal USB Installer." Linux is generally much lighter on system resources, which can directly help improve battery life and performance. 